

Chapter 86 - Victory

Tamanvi Ski Resort's advanced slope spans 879 meters in total, with a maximum gradient of 26 degrees, minimum gradient of 12 degrees, and average gradient of 18 degrees. Although the advanced slope doesn't prohibit beginners from entering, beginners must be accompanied by instructors and safety personnel if they want to ski the advanced slope.

So when Feng Yue and that Vivian had just gotten off the cable car, two staff members approached to ask if they needed safety personnel to accompany them.

After Yan Lin explained the situation, the staff understood and told Feng Yue that their advanced slope had loop snow vehicles alongside it that beginners could take down.

Martin and Yan Lin both appeared experienced, especially Martin, who was probably a regular at Tamanvi Ski Resort. After he explained to the staff that the two were going to have a friendly competition, the staff showed great interest in this contest.

Tamanvi Ski Resort had three advanced slopes in total. The staff led them to the one with the fewest people and even dispatched safety personnel to do a small clearance of skiers on that slope.

The ski resort was very supportive of this kind of competition; they even had a complete set of procedures to service such private competitions.

Both Yan Lin and Martin were skilled at snowboarding. Their competition should really be held in a snowboard park with jumps and obstacles, but since this was a spur-of-the-moment decision, they could only compete in speed on the resort's advanced slope.

The two needed to start from the starting point simultaneously and ski at full speed to the finish line to grab the flag. There would be no tourist interference along the entire slope, but small hills or other obstacles on the snow trail were unpredictable, so these would become key factors affecting their speed. How to avoid these obstacles was also something both needed to pay attention to.

This competition was impromptu. Feng Yue thought they just needed to go up and then ski down, but what she didn't expect was that the resort staff even brought over two drones to film their competition.

Feng Yue couldn't understand this until Yan Lin, while checking her snowboard, told her that Martin seemed to be quite famous at this ski resort and was also a professional ski instructor.

Because the staff needed time to prepare, more and more tourists learned about this small competition. More and more skiing enthusiasts took the cable car up from the foot of the mountain, all gathering at the summit to watch this competition.

Feng Yue even spotted three familiar figures in the crowd.

"Cousin! Cousin-in-law!" Feng Yue called out and waved to the three people not far away.

The siblings were very surprised to see her here, but remembering the rumors they'd heard from others, they instantly understood why Feng Yue was staying here.

"Is the Chinese person competing with Martin Yan?!" Diana looked at Yan Lin, who was checking her snowboard beside Feng Yue, and exclaimed.

Hearing this, Yan Lin looked up at her and nodded, then turned to ask Feng Yue, "A Yue, do you have a hair tie? I want to tie up my hair."

Feng Yue rummaged in her bag for a long time but couldn't find anything. Just as Yan Lin was about to stand up and ask the nearby staff, Feng Yue suddenly reached up and took off her hat and goggles.

Then she untied a hair tie from her own head and handed it to Yan Lin. "Here."

Feng Yue's sequence of actions was smooth and natural. By the time Yan Lin blankly accepted what she handed over, she realized what she had done.

The siblings Jiang Ming and Jiang Zhao looked at her with hesitation, and Jiang Zhao even raised his eyebrows slightly with a knowing look in his eyes.

"Thank you." Yan Lin looked at the hair tie in her hand, lowered her eyes, and slightly curved her lips.

"Mm." Feng Yue calmly put on her hat and goggles, then turned to chat with the three of them.

The three listened to Feng Yue recount what had happened and all frowned. Jiang Ming even directly gave that woman's whole family a cordial greeting¹.

"But..." Diana suddenly remembered something. "Can Yan really beat Martin? He's very good, and Yan's board isn't that great."

Hearing this, Jiang Zhao also frowned. He stepped forward to Yan Lin's side. "Miss Yan, if you need it, I can switch boards with you."

Yan Lin understood his good intentions and smiled slightly. "It's fine. Although it's indeed not very good, it won't fail to get through this run. Thank you for your kindness."

Jiang Zhao was still worried. He knew he couldn't persuade Yan Lin, so he wanted to find Feng Yue to persuade her instead, but before he could tell Feng Yue, the competition between Yan Lin and Martin was about to begin.

The two stood side by side at the starting point on the summit, two meters apart. A staff member stood between them. "Guests, we've cleared all the tourists from the slope, but the obstacles and small imperfections on the slope are beyond our control. Plus it's snowing a bit now, so please be careful. Whoever grabs the flag first wins this competition. Good luck!"

"Mm."

"Alright."

With the staff member's command, both figures shot down like arrows released from their bows, followed by two drones controlled by staff members.

Yan Lin, dressed in light cyan ski wear, almost instantly broke through the snow curtain and became a small black dot in everyone's eyes.

The people remaining at the summit watched the two compete through the drones brought by staff, naturally dividing into two groups.

Those who could ski on advanced slopes were mostly regulars at the resort, so naturally they knew Martin and cheered for him more.

Vivian listened to everyone's discussion and support for her boyfriend, proudly glancing at Feng Yue's side.

However, Feng Yue didn't look at her at all, instead calmly watching the footage transmitted on the computer screen.

On screen, Yan Lin was like a knight breaking through the heavens, traveling through the heavy snowfall, making people's blood boil with excitement.

As time passed, everyone gradually noticed something was wrong. A tourist said, "Hey, this lady can ski about as well as Martin, and Martin can't even pull ahead of her!"

"Yeah, how can Martin not even beat an amateur enthusiast?"

"I think this lady will win!"

Everyone's discussions rose and fell, and Vivian's expression became increasingly ugly.

That damn Martin couldn't even outski an Asian woman!

Compared to Vivian's frustration, Martin, who was competing, was shocked in his heart.

At the beginning, he was still thinking about going easy on her since it was Vivian's fault anyway. But when he really started skiing, he was immediately left behind by Yan Lin for a stretch, and only then did Martin react and begin skiing at full speed.

But even when he gave it his all, he could only match her speed, unable to pull ahead or shake her off.

Everything on the slope was unpredictable; they couldn't just continue in harmony forever.

The first to sense something wrong was Yan Lin. When she was changing edges on her snowboard, she discovered that this section had very little powder snow and was mostly already-formed ice. And once there was ice, there could be protruding foreign objects on the slope.

Yan Lin couldn't continue at full speed and instead reduced her speed slightly to better avoid those objects. When Martin saw her slow down, he thought she was running out of stamina, so he wanted to take this opportunity to pull ahead decisively.

But it was precisely at this moment that when Martin was changing edges to move forward, his front edge suddenly hit a protruding chunk of hard ice. He was knocked off balance and nearly fell to the ground.

Fortunately, he managed to steady himself and jumped forward a bit with his snowboard, thus avoiding falling.

At this time, Yan Lin had finally finished skiing through this section and arrived at the last place on the slope that required turning.

The snow was falling quite heavily now. Martin was already two body lengths behind Yan Lin. As long as they both maintained this speed for the final stretch, Yan Lin's victory was certain.

The tourists watching the competition from the summit all praised Yan Lin. They were all skiing enthusiasts, and their words were full of appreciation for Yan Lin.

Vivian's expression became extremely ugly, especially when she saw the scene on screen of that woman grabbing the flag. She even wanted to turn around and leave.

But Jiang Ming and Diana blocked her path. "Miss, planning to leave after losing?"

As Jiang Ming's words fell, Martin also skied to the finish line.

Jiang Ming turned and pointed at the computer screen. "You lost. You're not going to be poor sports, are you?"

Vivian was blocked at the summit. Looking at the obviously unfriendly Jiang Ming and Diana, her arrogant attitude was suppressed considerably.

The two just blocked her there until Yan Lin, holding the flag, and the dejected Martin returned to the summit by cable car.

Most of the spectating tourists were very familiar with Martin and were now surrounding him to tease him.

There were too many accidents on ski slopes; no one could be invincible forever. Even if Martin lost, it wouldn't affect his image in everyone's hearts.

But Vivian had to pay for her previous loose tongue.

Yan Lin walked to Feng Yue's side holding the flag, her eyes full of high spirits. She handed the small red flag to Feng Yue, her voice clear and bright. "A Yue, I won!"

Feng Yue looked at the small red flag in her hands. After a long while, a smile bloomed on her lips. "Congratulations."

Yan Lin felt much more cheerful in her heart from getting even this tiny response from Feng Yue.

She turned around, looked at the gloomy-faced Vivian, walked a few steps toward her, and looked down at this woman condescendingly. "Your stupidity has brought you and your lover to this situation. He's done what he should do. Now it's time for you to do what you should do."

The woman stood there. She didn't want to apologize—she didn't want to apologize to these stupid Chinese people!

But the people standing behind and beside her were all staring at her menacingly, and even those spectators were asking Martin why they were competing and whether there was some kind of bet.

If she didn't apologize, she would become a target of public criticism.

This was Vancouver, the Canadian city with the most Chinese people.

Vivian felt her face burning hot, as if she'd been slapped in public. She paced over to Feng Yue and stammered, "Sorry... I take back those words."

Feng Yue looked at her indifferently without saying a word. Just when everyone thought Feng Yue would turn and leave directly, Feng Yue condescendingly rolled her eyes at Vivian and spat out two Chinese characters: "Shǎbī²." Then she turned and left.

Feng Yue wasn't some good-tempered Buddha who would smile and forgive others after being cursed with racially discriminatory language. She couldn't do such a thing.

Finally, it was Yan Lin who told Martin to take his girlfriend away, and only then was the matter settled.

Seeing that the snow in the sky seemed to be falling heavier, the tourists staying at the summit scattered to prepare for going down the mountain.

The five had finally gathered at the advanced slope with difficulty, so they thought about skiing down together and then returning to the hotel for a hot spring bath.

But Jiang Ming looked at the eager Feng Yue and suddenly said, "Xiao Yue hasn't skied an advanced slope before, right? Why don't I accompany you down on the snow vehicle?"

"No need, I'll just ski slowly. If it really doesn't work, I'll sit-ski³ down." Feng Yue said with a laugh.

She wouldn't admit that watching Yan Lin's free and unrestrained appearance during the competition through the drone had made her feel excited too.

She wanted to try the advanced slope.

"I'll follow behind her. Don't worry." Yan Lin said to Jiang Ming, who still wanted to persuade her.

Jiang Ming looked at Feng Yue, who nodded at her, and could only follow behind Jiang Zhao and leave first.

Feng Yue watched them leave, glanced at Yan Lin, "Let's go."

"Alright."

As their words fell, Feng Yue stepped on her snowboard and rushed down the slope.

Footnotes:

1. "cordial greeting" - A euphemistic way of saying Jiang Ming cursed out the woman's family
2. "Shǎbī" (傻逼) - A vulgar Chinese insult meaning "stupid cunt" or "dumbass"
3. "sit-ski" - Sliding down on one's bottom, a beginner/emergency technique